



codev for developers

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Monitor dilemma

Please help me out as I am very confused with monitors and their model numbers. My budget is about 10 to 20k. I need a 24- to 27-inch LED backlit monitor with good refresh rate and color output. It should have DVI, HDMI or DisplayPort connectivity options. All other fancy looks, USB hub etc are secondary preferences. I want more of performance. A quick search suggested these ones - HP Pavilion 27xi, ASUS PA24HQ, Dell UltraSharp U2412m.

Hoping for a (quick) response.

Harshit Singhal



Dell UltraSharp U2412m

A If you want a 27-inch monitor, we would suggest you go for the BenQ GW2760HS which comes for around ₹19,500. This monitor has one of the best contrast ratios that we have ever come across and it performs decently well while watching HD movies and while gaming.

Dell Ultrasharp U2412m is another good monitor for the price it is being offered. It comes for around ₹19,000 and has a 16:10 aspect ratio giving a maximum resolution of 1920x1200.

The ASUS PA246Q is a professional monitor, which is great if you are an imaging professional. It gives you countless options to tweak colours which is a prime necessity if you want accurate colours while working in Photoshop or while editing videos. But for pure home use it is an overkill as it is priced around ₹35,000 which is ₹15k over your budget. We would suggest you go for either the Dell Ultrasharp U2412m or BenQ GW2760HS.

Different rigs

I am planning to buy a new PC to replace my 7-year old one. I have a 23-inch all in one PC

with TV on mind. A second option I thought of is Buying a led TV and a compact CPU with decent configs, which might be cheaper to buy. I checked out HP 23-inch AIO with intel i5, touch screen, TV and costs ₹60k.

Please give me your opinion so that I can make a decision. Thanking you in advance for an early reply.

Praveen Dev

A I would suggest you opt for an assembled PC in favour of an all-in-one for the simple reason that you can change your components as and when you feel the need in the future. With an all-in-one PC, your upgrading options will be limited. Unless you have very, very limited desk-space, I would suggest you get yourself an assembled PC.

Regarding touchscreens, well I personally think of it as a gimmick and it will not really help you much with productivity as such. A touchscreen makes sense on a 13-inch and lower laptop and on tablets, but having a 20-inch plus touchscreen monitor, does not really add any value to your overall productivity.

As for the other option that you suggested, of using a compact system and using your LED TV as the screen, well that can be an option provided you are willing to manage time between watching TV and using your system.

Keeping your ₹60k budget in mind, we will provide you with two rig options, one involving a mid-range gaming system and the other involving a small form factor system with an LED TV.

Mid range gaming rig

- Processor: Intel Core i5-3450 – ₹11,500
- Motherboard: Gigabyte GA-B75M-D3H – ₹4,200
- RAM: Corsair Vengeance 4GB – ₹2,500
- HDD: Seagate 1TB – ₹3,900
- Monitor: BenQ G2420HD – ₹9,800
- Graphics Card: ZOTAC GTX 650Ti BOOST – ₹12,000
- Cabinet: Antec One S3 – ₹3,000
- PSU: Corsair GS 600 – ₹4,800
- Speaker: Altec Lansing V2621 – ₹2,200
- Optical Drive: Samsung 22x SATA DVD writer – ₹950
- Mouse and Keyboard combo – ₹2,400
- Total – ₹57,250

Compact system with LED TV

- Processor: Intel Core i5-3450 – ₹11,500
- Motherboard: ZOTAC Z77X-ITX A-E – ₹10,100
- Corsair Vengeance 4GB – ₹2,500
- HDD: Seagate 1TB – ₹3,900
- Graphics Card: ZOTAC GTX 650Ti BOOST – ₹12,000
- Cabinet: Cooler Master Elite 120 Advanced – ₹2,799
- PSU: Cooler Master Thunder 500W – ₹3,400
- Optical Drive: Samsung 22x SATA DVD Writer – ₹950
- Keyboard and Mouse combo: Microsoft Desktop 2000 Wireless combo – ₹1,900
- LED TV: Samsung UA22F5100AR 22-inch full HD LED TV – ₹15,900
- Total – ₹64,949

Which portable drive to get?

Q) I urgently require a 1TB portable hard disk and my budget is around ₹5,000. I short-listed three of them viz.

- 1) Seagate Backup Plus 1TB Hard Drive (Blue)
- 2) WD My Passport 1 TB External Hard Disk (Blue)
- 3) Adata DashDrive HD710 1TB External Hard Drive (Black-Blue)

I want to know which of the above is the best performer. I also want to know whether it is safe to buy it from Snapdeal or Flipkart?

Roubhya Shankar Aluni

A Of the three drives that you have listed, the Seagate Backup Plus 1 TB one is a better performer than the other two and also offers social media backup features such as backing up your Facebook and Flickr photos and YouTube videos.



ADATA HD710